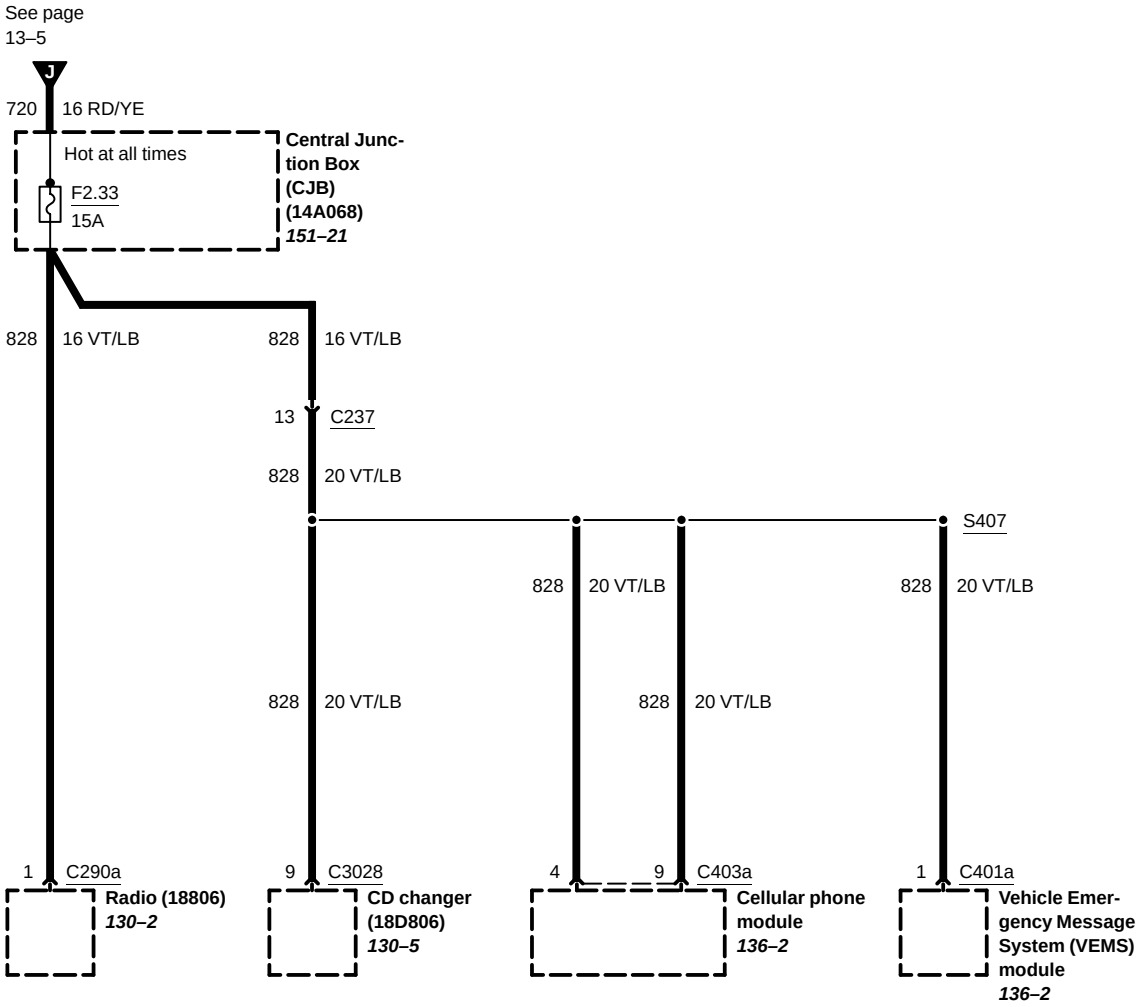F2.33, Early production